

FAST Connect

User Guide

Course Title: Technical and Business Writing

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1. Introduction

FAST Connect is a web platform that brings current students and graduates (alumni) of FAST-NUCES together in one place. Students can ask questions about careers, internships, degree applications and Final Year Projects (FYP), while alumni can share their experience and guide the next generation.

The platform has two main parts: a Q&A Forum, where members post questions and read replies, and an Alumni Directory, where members find graduates by name, department, campus and batch.

This guide is written for first-time users who can use a web browser but have never used FAST Connect. It is intended for FAST-NUCES students and alumni. After reading it, you will be able to create an account, log in and out, understand the main screen, browse and post in the Q&A Forum, search the Alumni Directory, edit your profile and contact the team through the Feedback page.

NOTE: Advice from other members is not an official university decision. Always confirm deadlines, eligibility and approvals with the relevant institution.

2. Requirements

- **A device –** a phone, tablet, desktop or laptop with an internet connection and a web browser.
- **Accounts –**
    - ➔ *For students:* a valid university email address ending in @nu.edu.pk.
    - ➔ *For alumni:* any personal email address.
- A password of your choice that you can remember and keep private.

3. Getting Started

3.1 Create a Student Account

Open FAST Connect and click Sign Up. On the account selection screen (Figure 1), choose the card that matches your status.

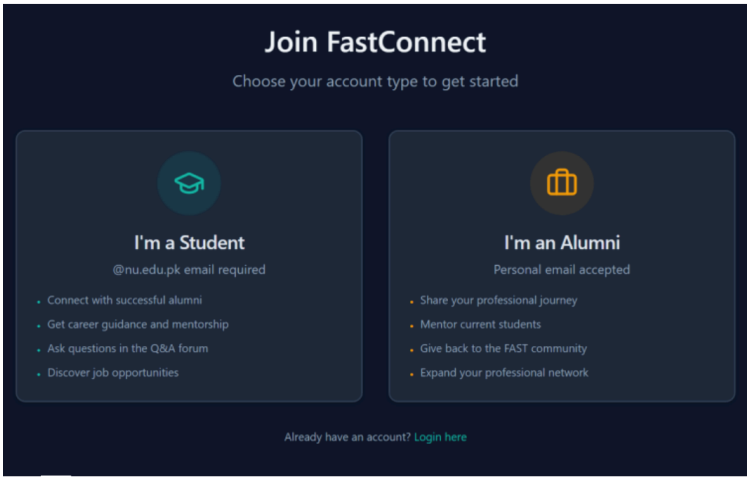


Figure 1. *Account selection: (1) Student card, (2) Alumni card.*

1. Click I’m a Student. The Student Registration form opens (Figure 2).
2. Type your First Name, Last Name and University Email.
3. Select your Campus, Department and Batch Year from the drop-down lists.
4. Click Upload Photo and select a picture if you wish. This step is optional.
5. Type a Password, then type it again in Confirm Password.
6. Click Create Student Account and read the message shown on the screen.

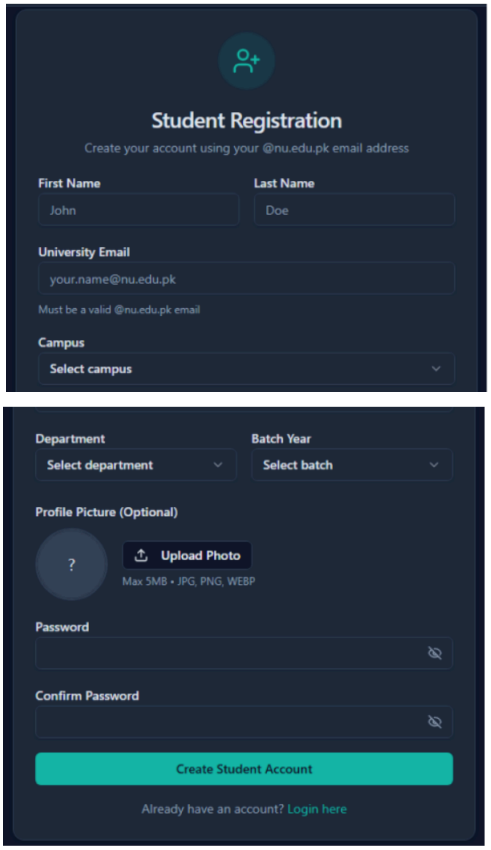


Figure 2. *Student registration: (1) identity, (2) academic details, (3) photo, (4) password, (5) Create Student Account.*

NOTE: If a field shows an error, correct it and submit again. Do not create a second account because the response is slow.

TIP: If you already have an account, select **Already have an account? Login here** at the bottom of the page.

3.2 Create an Alumni Account

Alumni follow a similar process, with extra professional details (Figure 3).

1. Click I'm an Alumni on the account selection screen.
2. Type your name and Email Address. Phone Number is optional.
3. Select your Campus, Department and Graduation Year.
4. Enter your Current Company, Current Position, City, Country and LinkedIn Profile URL.
5. Click Add Company only if you want to list previous employers.
6. Enter and confirm your password, then click Create Alumni Account.

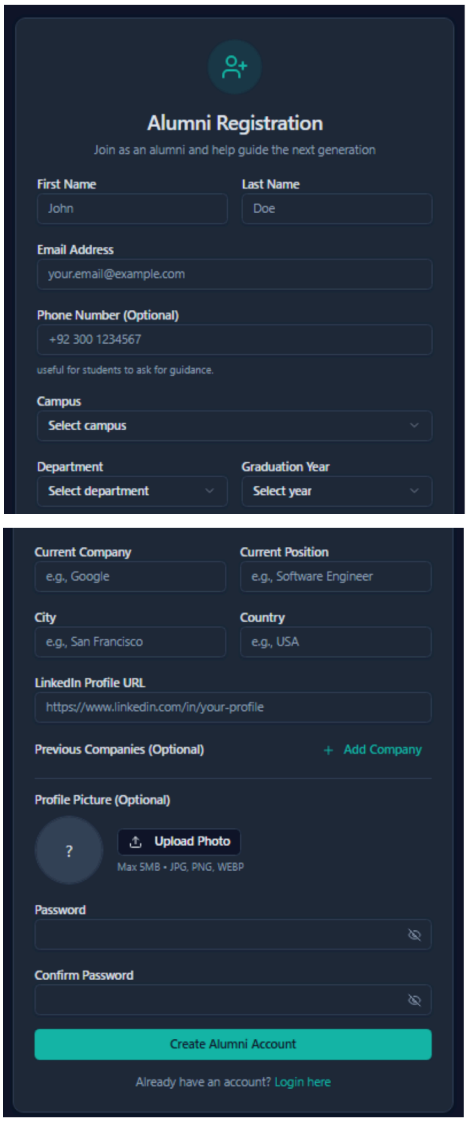


Figure 3. *Alumni registration: (1) identity, (2) university details, (3) professional details, (4) password and submission.*

WARNING: Keep your password private. Never type it into a forum question or a feedback message.

3.3 Log In and Log Out

1. Click **Login** in the top bar (If you already have an account), or click Login here below a registration form (Figure 4).
2. Type the email address you registered with in Email Address.
3. Type your password in Password.
4. Leave Remember me unticked if you are using a shared computer.
5. Click Login. If access fails, check your email and password and try again.

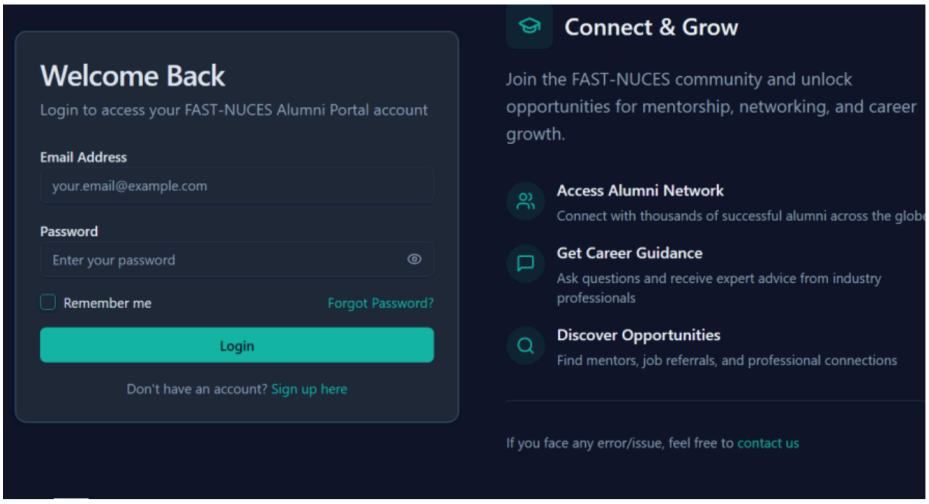


Figure 4. *Login screen: (1) Email, (2) Password, (3) Remember me, (4) Forgot Password?, (5) Login.*

To log out.

1. Click your profile picture in the top-right corner.
2. Choose Logout from the menu (Figure 5).
3. Always do this before leaving a shared device.

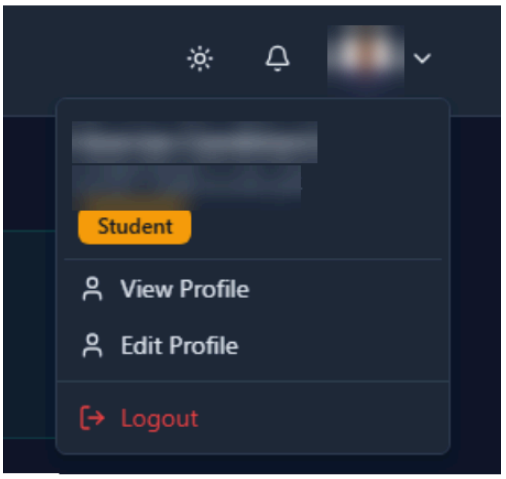


Figure 5. *Profile menu: (1) View Profile, (2) Edit Profile, (3) Logout.*

3.4 Reset a Forgotten Password

1. Open the login screen and click Forgot Password?.
2. Follow the instructions shown on the page that opens.
3. If the page does not work, contact the team through Feedback (Section 5.5).

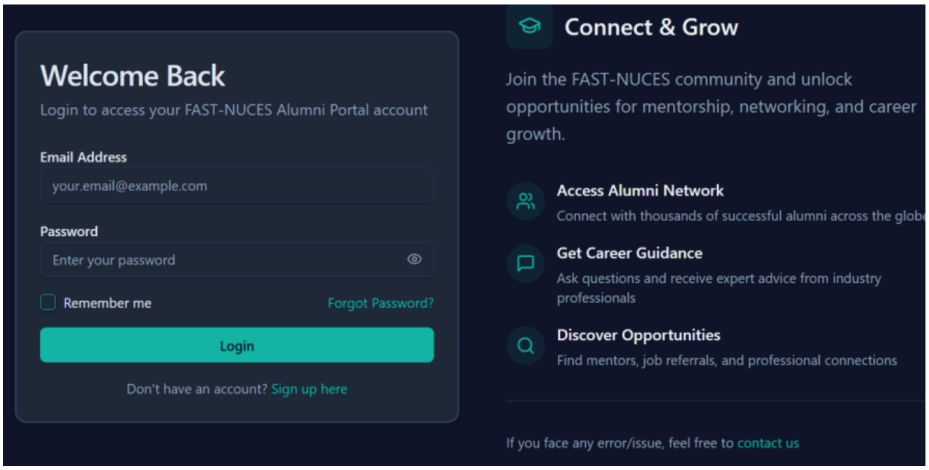


Figure 4. *Login screen: (1) Email, (2) Password, (3) Remember me, (4) Forgot Password?, (5) Login.*

4. Interface Overview

After you log in, the Home screen appears (Figure 6). The top navigation bar contains Home, Alumni Directory, Q&A Forum and Feedback. On the right of the bar are a theme icon, a notification bell and your profile picture, which opens the profile menu. The areas marked on Figure 6 are explained in Table 1.

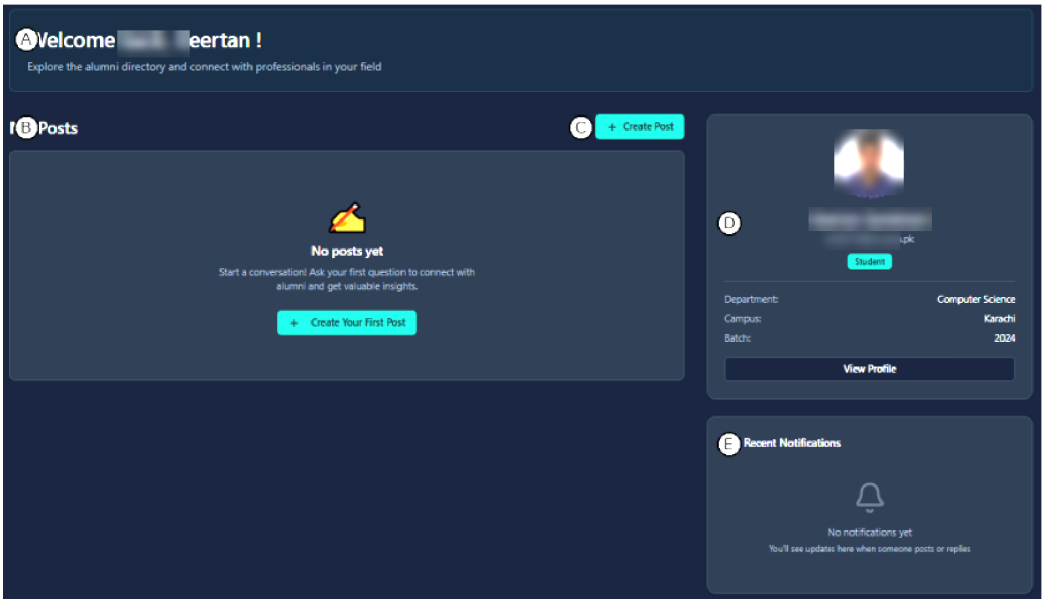


Figure 6. *Home screen with areas A to E.*

Table 1. *Key to Figure 6*

Key	Area	Purpose
A	Welcome banner	Confirms that you are signed in.

Key	Area	Purpose
B	Posts	Lists your own posts, or says “No posts yet”.
C	Create Post	Starts a new post.
D	Profile card	Shows your name, department, campus and batch, with a View Profile button.
E	Recent Notifications	Shows recent activity, or an empty message.

Clicking the bell opens the Notifications panel (Figure 7). The message “No notifications yet” is normal for new accounts; it does not mean something is broken.

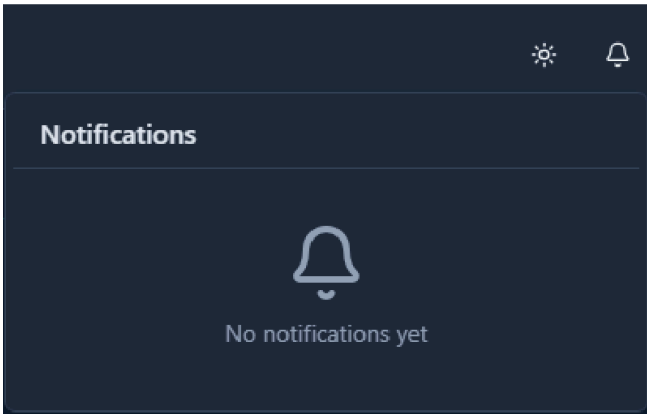


Figure 7. *Notification panel: (1) bell icon, (2) empty notification state.*

5. Essential Tasks

5.1 Browse and Read Questions in the Q&A Forum

1. Click Q&A Forum in the top navigation bar.
2. Scroll down the list of question cards (Figure 8).
3. Read each author’s name, role and the question title.
4. Click See more… to expand a question that is shortened.
5. Check the heart count and reply count at the bottom of each card to see how popular the question is.

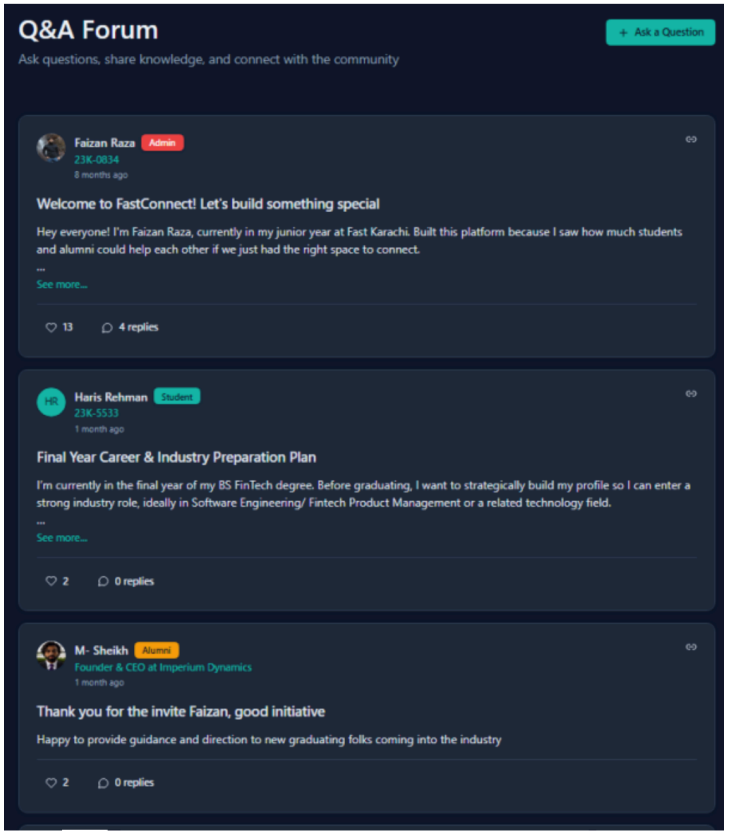


Figure 8. *Q&A Forum: (1) Ask a Question, (2) author, (3) title and text, (4) See more, (5) heart and reply count.*

5.2 Ask a Question

1. Open the Q&A Forum and click Ask a Question (Figure 8, mark 1).
2. Type a specific Question Title, such as “Which skills should I practise for a backend internship?”.
3. Explain your background, what you have tried and the help you need in Question Details.
4. Review both fields and delete any personal information.
5. Click Post Question, then check the forum to confirm that your question appears.
6. To leave without posting, click Cancel or the × in the upper-right corner of the dialog.

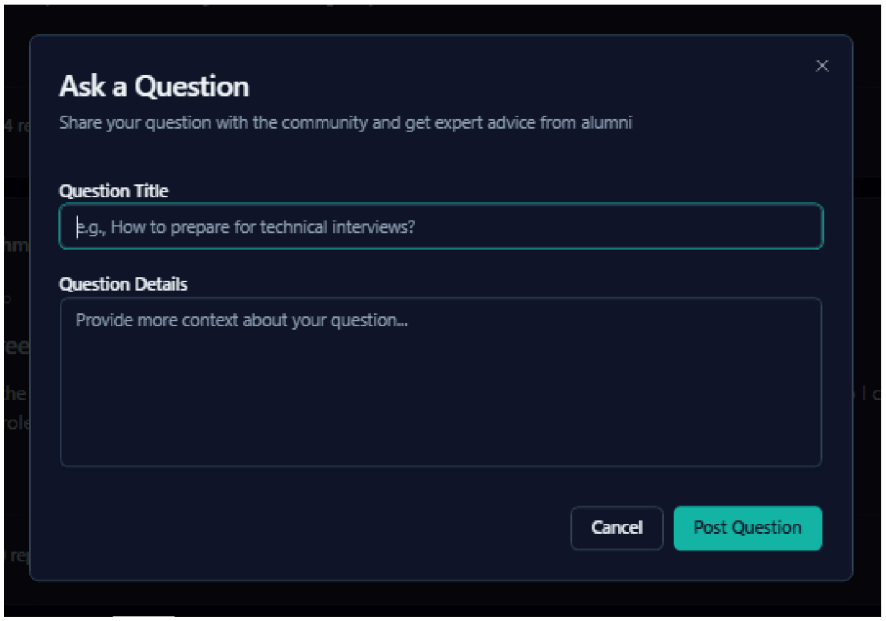


Figure 9. *Ask a Question dialog: (1) title, (2) details, (3) Cancel, (4) Post Question.*

WARNING: Never post a CNIC number, home address, password or private academic record in a public question.

5.3 Search the Alumni Directory

1. Click Alumni Directory in the top navigation bar (Figure 10).
2. Type a name in the Search by name box, if you know one.
3. Choose a department, campus or batch from the drop-down lists to narrow the results.
4. Click Search and read the number of alumni found.
5. Read the member cards to see each person's company, position, department and location.
6. If nothing useful appears, remove a filter or check the spelling and search again.

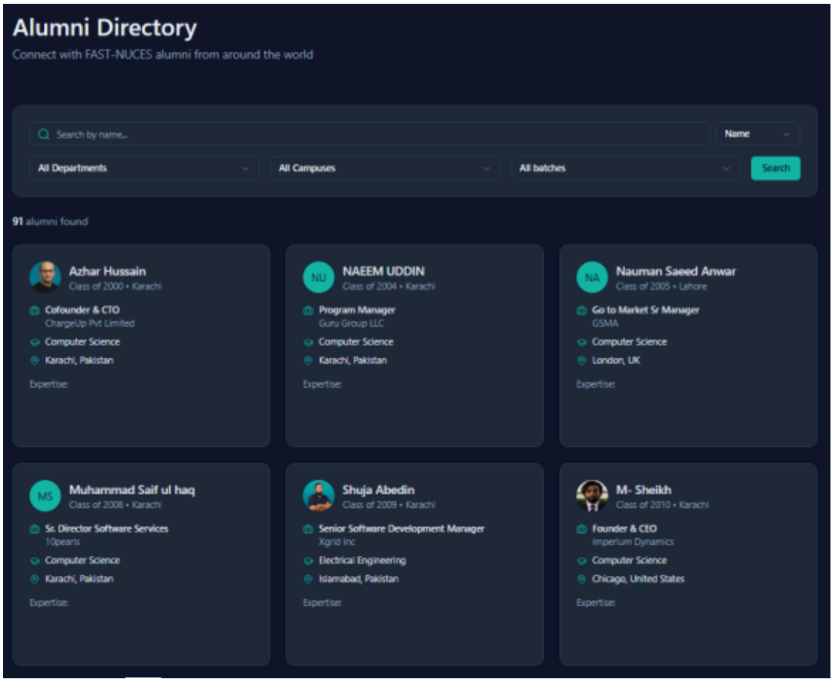


Figure 10. *Alumni Directory: (1) name search, (2) department, (3) campus, (4) batch, (5) Search, (6) member cards.*

NOTE: The directory only helps you find alumni. It does not send a mentoring request. To seek advice, post a clear question in the Q&A Forum.

5.4 Edit Your Profile

1. Click your profile picture and choose Edit Profile (Figure 5).
2. Review your Email, Department and Campus under Account Information (Figure 11). These are for reading only.
3. Change your First Name or Last Name under Personal Information if needed.
4. Click Change Photo and choose a JPG, PNG or WEBP picture up to 5 MB.
5. Click Save Changes. The button turns on only after you make a change.

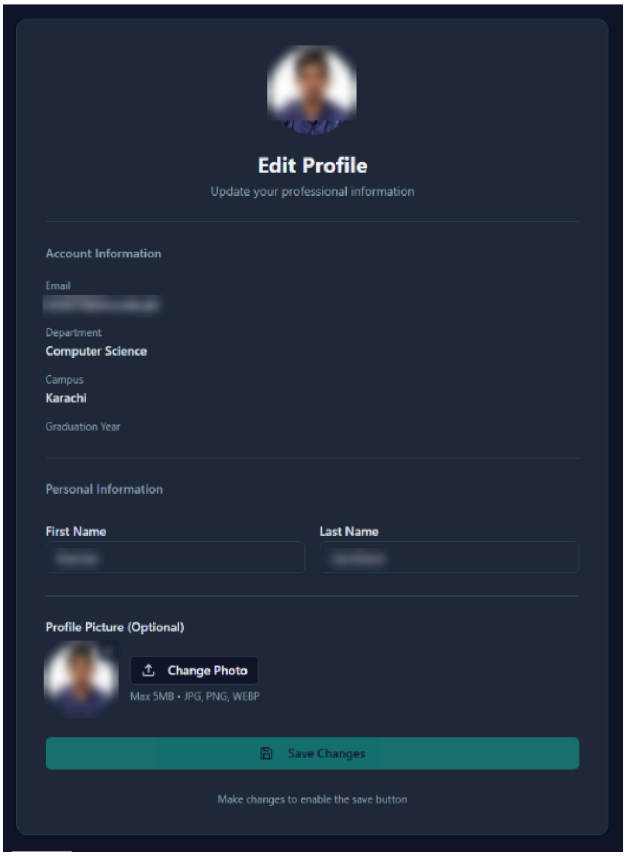


Figure 11. *Edit Profile: (1) account information, (2) name fields, (3) Change Photo, (4) Save Changes.*

WARNING: Save your edits before leaving the page. Use only a photo and name you are comfortable showing to other members.

5.5 Send Feedback or Ask for Help

1. Click Feedback in the top navigation bar (Figure 12).
2. Type a short Subject that names the problem.
3. Describe the page, what you tried and any error message in Message.
4. Click Send Feedback and wait for the on-screen response before sending again.

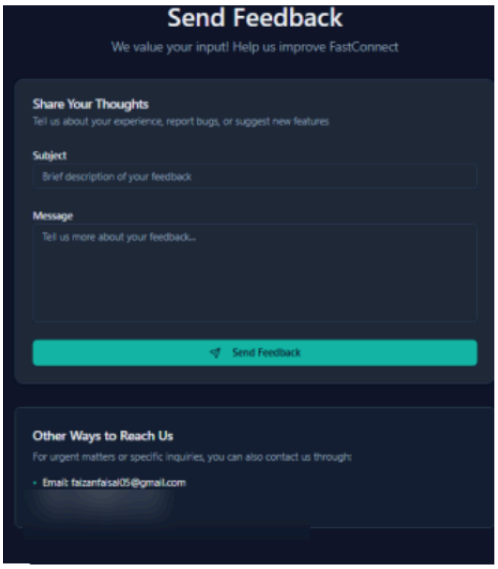


Figure 12. *Feedback page: (1) Subject, (2) Message, (3) Send Feedback, (4) Other Ways to Reach Us.*

If the form does not work, use the contact details listed under Other Ways to Reach Us. You can also use Feedback to report an inappropriate post: give the post title and author, and describe the problem briefly.

6. Troubleshooting

Table 2 lists common problems and their solutions.

Table 2. *Common problems and solutions*

Problem	Likely cause	Solution
Student email is rejected	Wrong domain or a typing mistake	Use your correct @nu.edu.pk address.
Passwords do not match	The two entries differ	Retype Password and Confirm Password carefully.
Photo is not accepted	Wrong format or file too large	Use a JPG, PNG or WEBP file of 5 MB or less.
Save Changes is disabled	No edit has been made yet	Change your name or photo first.
Cannot log in	Wrong email or password	Re-enter your details, or use Forgot Password?.
No alumni results	Filters are too narrow	Remove some filters and search again.

Problem	Likely cause	Solution
Question is not posted	A field is empty or the request failed	Check the title, details and any message, then try again.
Page does not load	Connection or browser problem	Check your connection and reload. Copy your text first.

7. Tips for Safe and Effective Use

- Write specific question titles. Clear titles attract better answers than vague ones such as “Need help”.
- Add background to your question: your semester, what you have tried and what you need.
- Search the forum before posting, in case someone has already asked the same thing.
- Never share passwords, CNIC numbers or other private details in a post or message.
- The screens show no privacy settings, so do not assume your profile details are hidden from other members.
- Be respectful, avoid repeated promotional posts and do not share another person’s contact details without permission.
- Log out on shared computers and leave Remember me unticked.
- Confirm advice about deadlines, fees and projects with your department or the institution concerned.

References

FAST Connect. (n.d.). FAST Connect: Students and alumni platform [Web application]. **https://fast-connect-nu.vercel.app/login?returnUrl=%2Fnotifications**

National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences. (n.d.). FAST-NUCES official website. https://khi.nu.edu.pk/